

Michael Vargo

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PROFESSIONAL OVERVIEW

City planner and data researcher with experience in transportation planning, environmental analysis, GIS, and policy evaluation. Proficient planner, public communicator, and data analyst seeking opportunities in land use policy, transportation, and strategic planning.

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistant | The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH Jan 2026 – May 2026
 - Course design, student assessment, and in-class instruction on topics related to land use and transportation, including demand modeling, transit-oriented development, and sprawl.
- Travel Demand Modeling Intern | Ohio Dept. of Transportation, Columbus, OH May 2025 – Dec 2025
 - Developed R tools that standardized analysis of more than 20 years of statewide travel forecast data, enabling future accuracy assessments.
 - Authored ODOT's first comprehensive report on statewide forecast accuracy in 11 years. This work detailed trends in forecast error and offered recommendations for data governance.
 - Supported FHWA research into forecast performance through testing and input on new methods to facilitate accuracy assessments by states and MPOs nationwide.
- Teaching Assistant | Académie de Strasbourg, Guebwiller, France Oct 2022 – April 2023
 - Led course design, assessment, and in-class instruction for groups of 15 to 25 students.
 - Engaged students in English language instruction through activity-based learning, individual tutoring, interdisciplinary lessons, and cultural activities.

EDUCATION

- Master of City & Regional Planning | Knowlton School, The Ohio State University 2024 – 2026
- Arabic – Intermediate-Advanced (3.5) | Middlebury Language School 2022
- Bachelor of Arts in Arabic, French, Political Science | The Ohio State University 2017 – 2021

RECOGNITION

- Knowlton School's Hazel Morrow Jones Award for Outstanding Graduate Student 2025, 2026

SKILLS

- Document Design Adobe InDesign, Canva, knitr, Quarto, Word
- Graphic Design Adobe Illustrator, Inkscape, ggplot2
- Web Design Quarto, GitHub Pages, Basic HTML, CSS, and JS
- 2/3D Modeling Sketchup
- Data Analysis Tidyverse, OLS & spatial models, Geo/Pandas, Excel
- Data Visualization ggplot2, Plotly, knitr, Shiny, Matplotlib, ArcGIS Insights
- GIS and Cartography ArcGIS Pro, ESRI Suite, QGIS, R-Spatial
- Programming Python, R, Github
- Stakeholder Engagement Public speaking, stakeholder interviews
- Planning and Policy Critical writing, policy evaluation, site assessment
- Languages English, French (C1-C2), Arabic (B1), Portuguese (Reading)